



Everyone is a founder

Tyler Lindow · Founder & CEO of beginner

Pre-seed · \$500k

Team

- Solo founder. 10 years building the bridge between makers and money.
- 6.5 years: payment tech, small-business onboarding · 3.5 years: museums & education.
- The thread: never the gatekeeper, always the bridge.

Problem

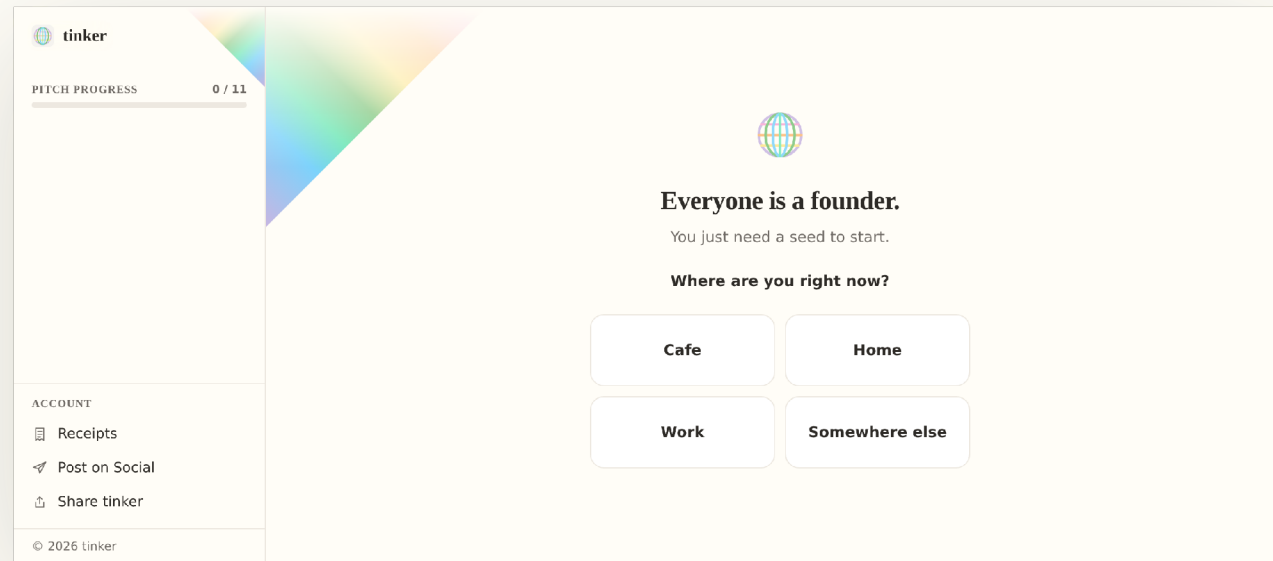
Strong builders sometimes never become founders.

The gap is fundraising — \$500–\$5,000 a month for a fractional coach or deck writer. The ones who can't pay stay builders.



Solution

A guided AI interview that turns conviction into a page seeders read. \$9/mo entry. Same deliverable as the coach. 1/100th the price.



Traction

10

paying users on tinker today. CAC: \$9/user (excludes infra/scaling). At the \$9/mo entry tier, LTV beats CAC inside month two.

Market

\$2.4B / year

1M aspiring founders globally × \$2,400 / year (Enterprise + community tier ACV).

The aspiring-founder market is the people who already buy fundraising coaches, accelerator prep, and pitch tools — at the price point where beginner clears them all.

Ask

\$500k → 4,000 paid users @ \$9/mo (~\$432k ARR) + 1 named accelerator deal in 12 months.

\$168k — founder cost (12 months: \$150k base + \$18k benefits). I need a salary; this is what it is.

\$200k — founder events, travel, accelerator BD. SD farmers-market activations, EvoNexus / SDSU / UCSD / Nucleate partnerships, accelerator pipeline trips.

\$132k — growth + infrastructure scaling. 4,000 users × \$9 CAC = \$36k paid; remainder covers funnel, community, and infra beyond a16z Speedrun credits.

Line in the sand: personal runway ends June 2026 — if the round doesn't close, I step away.

Thank you

Everyone is a founder